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Justin Adler

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

SUMMARY

Senior .NET Cloud Architect with 20+ years across real estate, fintech, and automotive - from early-stage startups to international consultancies. Deep expertise in the Microsoft stack (.NET to v10), Azure/AWS, and distributed backend systems. Comfortable owning the full stack of technical leadership: architecture, team building, delivery, and client engagement. A hands-on lead who stays close to the tools - I contribute technically while driving architecture, delivery, and team growth.

What I bring: faster delivery through tight, repeatable processes, healthy codebases built on solid engineering standards, cloud infrastructure that doesn't cost more than it should - and a team culture that fosters growth and continuous learning.

Experience

.NET Developer Lead - Angle Auto Finance (Australia)

Sep 2025 - March 2026

- Unified a fully remote team of 5 senior developers by introducing monthly in-office days, weekly standups, 1:1s, and group tech discussions - turning an isolated group into a cohesive team
- Designed and implemented new .NET 8 features for ASP.NET Core APIs and underlying SQL database components, delivering initiatives on schedule
- Raised code quality and consistency across repos via stronger coding standards and a stricter PR review process, reducing context-switching and acting as a quality guard rail before code reached production
- Eliminated hardcoded credentials and poor NuGet dependency management from CI/CD pipelines; added automated test gates to block failing builds from progressing
- Introduced structured JIRA requirements and acceptance criteria sessions with PO/BAs, noticeably reducing Change Request tickets raised during UAT
- Delivered new FIS Ambit Enterprise features (including Application tagging) to production within the first month - demonstrating fast ramp-up on unfamiliar enterprise software
- Led triage of production issues via Azure App Insights, targeting a 30-60 minute response SLA - directly unblocking front-end developers and testers and improving overall team throughput

Technology Lead - Syion.com (Australia + Singapore)

May 2024 - Jun 2025

- Organised 10 engineers across concurrent client projects using SCRUM - decomposed product requirements into JIRA tickets with estimates, descriptions, and acceptance criteria; ran fortnightly sprints with grooming and retros
- Modernised two legacy automotive dealership platforms from .NET Framework 4.6.2 to .NET 8; introduced Docker + docker-compose for a consistent local dev experience; cleaned up a fragmented multi-repo git process into a single-repo workflow; added New Relic for APM and error visibility
- Cut AWS spend by ~45% ($11K/month down to ~$6K/month) with further savings still available - eliminated over-provisioned resources and reduced dev environment costs to near-zero via a custom Slack commands that spins up resources on demand with an automatic 1-hour teardown
- Led on-site client engagement: requirements gathering, quoting, milestone tracking, and prioritisation - serving as the primary technical point of contact
- Elevated team capability through enforced PR + test review gates, consistent solution layouts, coding standards, and internal demos (e.g. hands-on Docker/docker-compose walkthroughs)

Senior Software Engineer - Homely.com.au (Australia)

2013 - May 2024

- Pivoted StreetAdvisor.com to Homely.com.au - owned the architectural decisions and code/data migration.
- Managed importing real estate agent data (up to tens of thousands of files/day) leveraging early Azure Cloud serverless architecture (Azure Cloud Services, VM's and Storage)
- Owned all Azure infrastructure decisions - selected resources, configured auto-scaling (e.g. App Service scaling on CPU/request metrics, capped at 10 instances but never exceeding 3 in practice), and maintained API response targets under 500ms
- Ran SCRUM ceremonies until a dedicated Scrum Master joined; pair programmed with and reviewed PRs for junior developers to accelerate their growth
- Led engineering hiring interviews - actively shortlisting candidates and assessing technical fit
- Collaborated with Product Owners to translate business requirements into clearly defined development initiatives delivered to production

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Senior Software Engineer - StreetAdvisor (Australia)

2007 - 2013

- Created StreetAdvisor.com (everything but Front End)
- Near-instant autocomplete for suburb and agent search under 100ms leveraging .NET and RavenDb
- Creation and maintenance of all On-Prem, then Co-Located then Azure infrastructure - built the business case and cloud migration - cutting new server provisioning from days to minutes and reducing monthly infrastructure costs by ~60%

- Geospatial mapping of suburbs. Including Point-in-Poly, WSG84 and early MSSql Geospatial tooling. Homely could then display all 'administrative boundaries' and also streets polys.
- Project management, scrum master, business analyst. Daily BAU. Collaborated with Product Owners to translate business requirements into clearly defined development initiatives delivered to production

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Software Engineer - Stargate Group (Australia)

2000 - 2007

- Created NetVal: first online property valuation portal in Australia
- Helped create and define the LIXI Valuations standard
- OnPrem DevOps for World Originate: Independent Property Loan Management software
- BAU maintenance/new features for World Originate. Migrated off VB.NET to .NET / C#. Added Testing and guardrails.

Technical Skills

BACKEND & APPLICATION DEVELOPMENT

- C# / .NET Full Framework to .NET 10
- RESTful API design
- Scalable microservices, inter-service communication, resiliency patterns, CQRS
- Event-driven systems (Azure Service Bus / RabbitMQ, Azure Event Grid)

CLOUD & DEVOPS ENGINEERING

- Azure (Functions, App Service, Container Service, Service Bus, Event Grid, Storage, KeyVault, FrontDoor, VMs) & AWS (S3, EC2, Lambda, Amplify, CloudWatch, DynamoDB, RDS, SQL Server)
- Containerisation (Docker / docker-compose)
- CI/CD (GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Jenkins)

OBSERVABILITY & PRODUCTION ENGINEERING

- Azure Monitor, Seq, New Relic, Sentry
- Structured logging & monitoring
- Open Telemetry (OTel with Azure App Insights)
- Production incident diagnosis & optimisation

TOOLING & SCRIPTING

- GitHub, Azure DevOps, JIRA, Slack, Teams

DATA ARCHITECTURE & STORAGE

- Relational Databases (MS SQL & PostgreSQL) - design, performance tuning, data security
- Non-Relational Databases (CosmosDB, RavenDB, MongoDB)
- Redis (caching strategies)
- ElasticSearch (search indexing & optimisation)

SECURITY & IDENTITY

- Azure Entra, Auth0, Okta, Identity Server
- Secure authentication & authorisation design (OAuth)
- API security best practices (OWASP, Dependabot, Snyk)

AI-AUGMENTED DEVELOPMENT

- Claude.ai
- GitHub Copilot
- OpenCode

- PowerShell & Bash
- Postman

Education

Bachelor of Applied Science (Computer Science)

RMIT University

Secondary Education

Geelong Grammar School